elections, sometimes by threats and blackmailing of democratic politicians who gradually left or were removed from the political scene.

In Yugoslavia, Communism legitimised itself above all by the Communist-led partisan resistance movement, which forcibly monopolised the struggle. Tito violently eliminated or skilfully discredited other political competitors and was recognised by the Allies as the local coalition partner. Later on, because of the 'fifty-fifty' agreement, Tito was allowed to play Stalin in his own backyard: in Yugoslavia, the immediate aftermath of the war was marked by the mass summary executions of Tito's political opponents. Tens of thousands at least, and probably many more, Yugoslav anti-Communist troops are believed to have perished in massacres in the dense woods of south-east Slovenia, near (once German-populated) Kočevje and elsewhere, in the early summer of 1945. By some estimates possibly as many as 200,000 died in total (in Kočevje and other places), some of whom were handed over to Yugoslavia by the British Army stationed in Austria, either by force or under the pretext of being moved to Italy after they had fled to Austria. (British Quaker John Corsellis provided us with a sympathetic account of the tragic fate of these refugees in his book *Slovenia 1945: Memories of Death and Survival after World War II*, IB Tauris, 2010.) So many years later, Slovenian forensic scientists are kept busy discovering hundreds of illegal mass-graves and the national psyche has not yet come to terms with what happened – or does not want to: this was the most radical 'cancel culture', though not unheard of in other parts of post-war Europe at the time. Such pogroms were largely kept secret at the time but local Communists attempted to legitimise them by smearing anti-Communists as Fascists and collaborators with the Nazis. (Some of them actually were but they represented a very small minority.) At the same time, anti-Communists effectively committed political suicide when they allowed themselves to be forced into what they termed 'technical' collaboration with the occupiers (something that happened in Western Europe too). This was indeed an irony, as these people were often Anglophiles, who hoped that Slovenia was going to be liberated by the British and the Americans, not by Communist partisans or, even worse, by the Soviets. Their worst nightmare – which in the light of the Nazi campaign was dismissed by the Allies as of secondary importance at best and as betrayal at worst – actually came true. Their fears had not been